Bali

UBUD · SIDEMEN · SIX NIGHTS

The wealth of small things.

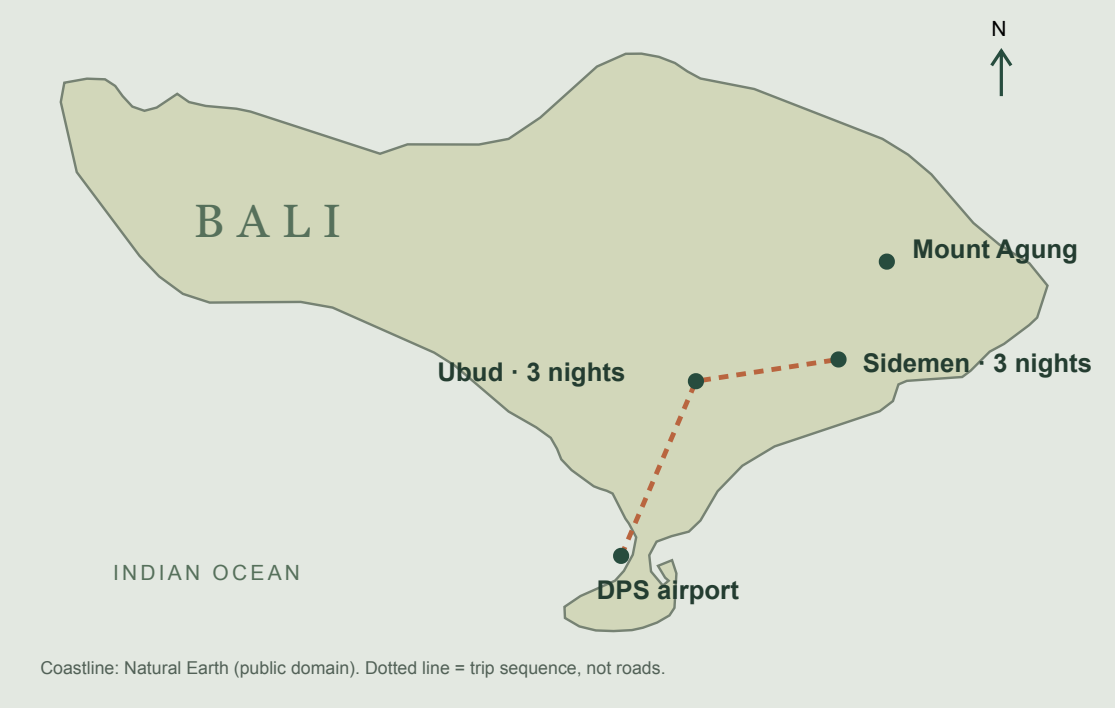
An artist's compound. A table of rice and spice. Two places, and enough time to know them.

A considered week for two, with a US$750 ground allowance.

PHOTOGRAPH: VYACHESLAV ARGENBERG / CC BY 4.0

Two bases.
A deeper field of view.

Three nights in Ubud for painting, lanes and good plates.
Three in Sidemen for fields, cloth and a long veranda.



1 **Arrive → Ubud**
Prearranged car; settle into the compound.

2 **Ubud, inside the frame**
Puri Lukisan, lunch, then an optional dance.

3 **A rice-field morning**
Guided walk; Kedewatan chicken rice.

4 **East to Sidemen**
Direct transfer; afternoon on the terrace.

5 **Water, paths, working land**
A local guide and a short field walk.

6 **Threads of the valley**
A prearranged weaving visit; free afternoon.

7 **Sidemen → airport**
Leave a generous road and check-in margin.

Ubud on foot 04
A room with character 05
The second horizon 07
The honest budget 10



Tegallalang, near Ubud. A landscape study, not a promised stop. Photograph: Vyacheslav Argenberg / CC BY 4.0. Cropped.

Green is an agreement.

A rice terrace looks like a contour line made solid. Behind that edge is an arrangement: who gets water, when it moves, and how neighbours live with its movement.

Bali's subak associations bring farmers together around irrigation. Water channels, temples, shared decisions and ritual belong to the same working landscape. The philosophy of *Tri Hita Karana* connects relationships among people, the divine and the natural world.

UNESCO's inscription recognises five particular cultural landscapes. It does not turn every green valley on Bali into a World Heritage site. Sidemen is included here for the chance to encounter a working countryside, without making that claim.

Look for a small channel before the sweeping view. The field may be water, stubble or seedlings when you arrive; luminous green is a moment in a cycle.

Stay on agreed paths. A narrow bund is farm infrastructure, not a public viewing platform.

Reading: UNESCO, Cultural Landscape of Bali; UNESCO, Voices of Water.

Begin with a painting. Let the town follow.

Ubud rewards an early start and a small radius. Build the day around one place worth looking at closely.

DAY 01 · ARRIVAL

A room, a meal, no deadline.

Book the airport pickup with the stay. Allow roughly 1½–2½ hours on the road to Ubud, more in heavy traffic; this is a planning estimate.

Find dinner near Hanoman or Goutama. A late arrival changes only the first meal.



Museum Puri Lukisan grounds. Chainwit. / CC BY 4.0. Cropped.

DAY 02 · ART & THE CENTRE

Keep the morning indoors.

Give Museum Puri Lukisan 90 minutes. Its story begins with concern that important Balinese works were leaving the island. Notice how figures occupy a painting's space; then look at the town again.

The visitor page lists daily opening 09:00–18:00 and Rp95,000 per adult; recheck before visiting. Walk toward the palace with a licensed guide. For an optional evening dance, choose the programme actually posted that day.

DAY 03 · FIELDS & LUNCH

Follow the water.

Ask the stay to arrange a licensed guide for an early walk on the Kajeng side of Ubud. Aim for 60–90 minutes, with the route chosen for current path conditions and access.

Take a car to Nasi Ayam Kedewatan Ibu Mangku for chicken rice. Kedewatan is outside the centre; allow time for this short outing.

Leave the afternoon free. In rain, swap the walk with the museum.

> Reserve guiding and the Day 4 car the evening before. Ask for the full vehicle price, waiting time and parking basis.

Museum visitor information · Museum's own history. Schedules and fees checked 29 October 2026.

The artist’s compound.

Jati Homestay	1 double room	Rp500,000
PADANG TEGAL · HANOMAN	TWO ADULTS · SHARED GROUNDS	NIGHTLY TARGET, NOT A QUOTE

A proper homestay, with enough character to be part of the trip.

Jati’s official gallery shows tiled floors, timber ceilings, simple wood furniture and balconies looking into greenery. Paintings appear in rooms and communal space. The attraction is a room inside a family compound, with Ubud outside the lane.

The listed Standard Double is 25 m², with air conditioning, a hot-and-cold shower and a private terrace or balcony. A Standard Twin is listed separately. This is the independent, Airbnb-style choice in the guide: a private guest room, not an entire villa or a self-catering apartment.

Pick Jati for its artist-family connection and intimate scale. Confirm noise and services before booking.

Ask for the room, not the promise.

Request the exact room’s recent bedroom and bathroom photographs. Confirm whether the terrace is upstairs, how luggage reaches it, and whether breakfast is included in the total.

Ask about nearby building work and late check-in. A leafy photograph cannot establish quiet; a Wi-Fi logo cannot establish speed.

> **The selection test**
> One room for two, six-night trip basket, taxes included. Compare the final three-night total with Rp1.5m. If it is higher, use the contingency or choose another central homestay after checking the same details.

Inspect Jati’s official gallery
jatihomestay.com/gallery
Scan or tap the link.

What the pictures can tell us

The official bedroom and shared-space gallery was inspected. Follow its link for room images; this guide does not reproduce commercial property photographs.

Source: Jati accommodation page. Room, breakfast, stairs, noise, cancellation and all-in price still require confirmation for chosen dates.

Rice at the centre.

Choose a plate with a point of view, then let the sambal set the pace.

KEDEWATAN · PLANNED LUNCH

Nasi Ayam Ibu Mangku

Go for the house's chicken-rice identity. The Ubud branch is on Jalan Raya Kedewatan; use its own menu link to check the current plate and additions. Order sambal separately if you want to control the heat.

GOUTAMA · EASY UBUD SUPPER

Warung Biah Biah

A central Indonesian-meal option on Jalan Goutama. Use it for the first evening, when a short walk matters more than a destination restaurant. Check the menu and opening at the door; the guide makes no live-hours promise.

TABOLA · SIDEMEN SUPPER

Warung Embang

Pair dinner with the family-run homestay. Ask what can be cooked that evening, and whether a cooking session can be arranged. Discuss dietary needs before the kitchen starts.

> **A useful order:** "Sambal terpisah" asks for sambal separately. Vegetarian diners should ask about stock, shrimp paste and fish ingredients, not only visible meat.

Ibu Mangku's own menus
linktr.ee/nasiayamkedewatanibumangku
Scan or tap the link.



Sate lilit, a Balinese minced-meat or fish satay style. Illustrative food photograph, not a dish photographed at these recommendations. Kresnanta / CC BY-SA 4.0. Cropped.

The second horizon.



Sidemen's hills in rain, December 2024. I Gede Krisna Dharmayudha / CC BY-SA 4.0. Cropped. Weather and field colour will vary.

The change is not only the view. It is the number of things you ask a day to hold.

04 / Travel east

Make the Ubud–Sidemen transfer the day's only commitment. Allow about 1½–2½ hours by car, depending on the exact stays and traffic. A direct transfer protects the afternoon; temple-and-waterfall detours consume it.

Check in, ask where it is welcome to walk, and locate dinner while it is still light. Roads through the valley are working roads, often without a pavement.

05 / A field morning

Arrange a local licensed guide for 1½–2 hours at a comfortable pace. Ask about irrigation, crop changes and access. Choose a route with no river crossing; turn back if a path is slippery or flooded.

06 / Cloth & a free afternoon

Ask the stay to confirm a working weaving visit the previous day. Pelangi Traditional Weaving is a lead to enquire about, not an appointment already made. The point is to see a process, not demand a performance.

Pay the agreed guide or demonstration charge. Buy only if you want the cloth, and ask who made it and how. Keep substantial textile purchases outside the food-and-room budget.

The afternoon belongs to the veranda, a second walk on an agreed road, or lunch extended by an hour. If rain takes the morning, move the indoor visit and leave the fields for another opening.

Before the cloth, the thread.

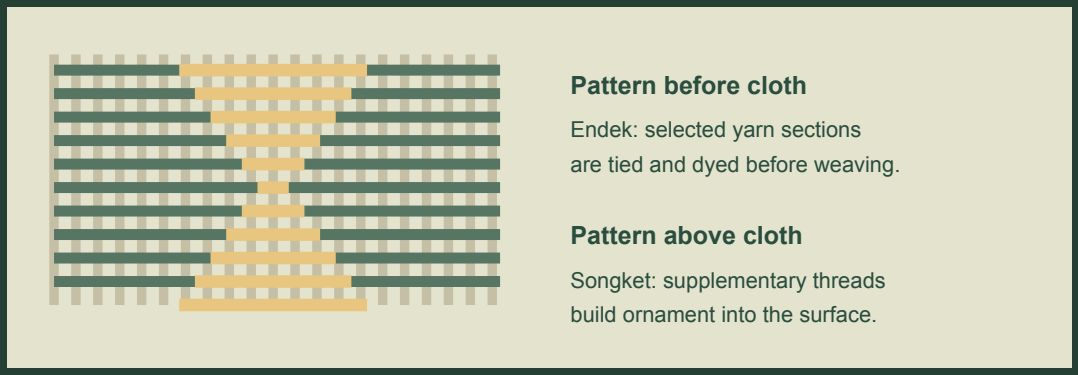
A patterned textile is a record of decisions made before it could be held up to the light.

In endek, parts of the yarn are bound and dyed before weaving. Colour arrives on the loom already carrying instructions. As thread crosses thread, the planned pattern appears. The slight softness at an edge is part of the visual pleasure of an ikat textile.

Songket works differently. Extra decorative threads enter the weave, producing ornament above the underlying structure. Gold- and silver-coloured threads are associated with ceremonial cloth; material, complexity and the maker's labour matter to its value.

Sidemen produces both. ITDC describes weaving here as inherited knowledge and ritual identity; endek also moves into contemporary clothing.

A finished length can be attractive at a glance. The arrangement of yarn, the counting and the repeated movement reveal what the glance has missed.



Original explanatory drawing. The abstract teaching pattern is not a named traditional motif, and the diagram is not a loom plan.

Ask how the pattern is made. The answer changes what you see.

At the workshop: ask who wove it, what the fibre is, and how it should be washed. Ask before photographing people. A working household can be busy or closed; arrange the visit ahead.

Cultural source: ITDC, Endek dan Songket Sidemen. Workshop lead corroborated by university field interviews; access remains unconfirmed.

A veranda is enough of a plan.

Start with a family bungalow. Spend more only for a particular room and the pleasure it buys.

Embang Homestay

The core-budget choice. A small family-run place in Tabola with simple bungalows and a warung. An independent Travelfish inspection describes fan-cooled rooms, verandas and hot-water bathrooms.

Allow Rp700,000 a night, subject to an actual quote. Confirm bungalow, bathroom, breakfast and total; do not assume air conditioning or a pool.

Owner-supplied listing & room gallery
Independent inspection, updated January 2025

Pondok Satu Hati 4

The considered upgrade. The official room gallery shows a timber bungalow, mosquito-netted bed, terrace, stone-tiled shower and wood vanity. The listing specifies a king-size bed, open-air bathroom, fan, hot water, breakfast and a shared pool.

There are steps and the host marks the property wheelchair-inaccessible. Published standard tariff: €61/night, not a May quote. Stated prepayments are non-refundable. Confirm the final IDR total and terms.

CHOOSE THIS	WHAT THE SPEND BUYS	RESOLVE FIRST
Embang Core basket	Hosted simplicity; dinner on site	Assigned bungalow, recent bath photos, cooling
Pondok Satu Hati 4 Upgrade allowance: +Rp1.5m / trip	Wooden bungalow, shared pool, breakfast	All-in May price, steps, non-refundable terms
Sawah Indah Alternative to compare	Pool and a broad range of room types	Budget vs annex room; stairs; exact total

See the actual bungalow and terms
pondoksatuhati.com/en/pondok-satu-hati-4
Scan or tap the link.

Room allowances are not quotes. Confirm availability and final totals. Sawah Indah listing. Commercial galleries are linked, not reproduced.

Taste, with a ceiling.

Rp12,000,000

About US$750 for two.
A planning basket, not a bookable package.



ROOMS 30% / FOOD 20% / TRANSPORT 18% / OTHER 20% / RESERVE 12% · rounded

Six nights, one double room Ubud 3 × Rp500k + Sidemen 3 × Rp700k; target totals include taxes	Rp3,600,000
Meals, coffee and drinking water Seven calendar days; includes breakfast if the room rate does not	Rp2,400,000
Airport legs, base transfer and local cars Prearranged quotes; no scooter rental assumed	Rp2,200,000
Local guides and a weaving visit Ubud orientation / field walk / Sidemen walk and visit	Rp1,200,000
Museum, optional dance and access costs Museum published fee: two adults × Rp95k; other costs estimated	Rp600,000
Bali visitor levy, if applicable Published Rp150k per person × two; check exemption rules	Rp300,000
Small practical costs Laundry, data, small tips or extras	Rp300,000
Uncommitted contingency Room-price changes, traffic, extra car or a missed inclusion	Rp1,400,000

What is outside the basket
Flights, visas, travel insurance, alcohol-heavy evenings, major shopping and expensive workshops. No paid bookings are assumed.

When the numbers move
The bungalow upgrade takes the target to Rp13.5m (~US$844). Arithmetic uses an assumed Rp16,000 = US$1, not a live exchange quote.

All line items are editorial allowances except the separately identified museum and levy tariffs. Reprice the full basket for actual dates; do not infer availability from this total.

The useful small print.

Choose the week

This fictional brief uses a May shoulder-season week, away from major holidays. May is generally within the drier part of the year; showers remain possible. No festival or ceremonial access is promised. Check the actual calendar before choosing dates.

Make the last day work

For the sample plan, choose an evening departure. Allow roughly 2½–3½ hours from Sidemen to DPS, plus the airline's check-in margin and an extra traffic buffer. Plan to leave about seven hours before an international flight.

For an early departure, replace the final night in Sidemen (Night 6 of the trip) with an airport-area night and reprice. Do not solve it by gambling on a predawn road estimate.

Agree the car price

Ask whether fuel, parking, tolls and waiting are included. Keep the stay's address and pickup instructions offline. Sidemen transport should be arranged ahead; do not assume a ride-hailing car will appear when needed.

Pack for the actual days

Grippy walking shoes, a light rain layer, hat, refillable bottle, insect repellent and a sarong or modest clothing. There is no scooter-driving or volcano-climbing requirement in this itinerary.

Visit with permission

Follow local guidance at temples; cover shoulders and legs as requested, use the required sarong and sash, and respect closures. Rituals and family compounds are not public stages. Ask before entering or photographing.

Bali's provincial visitor code calls for a licensed guide at tourist attractions. Guiding is therefore a line in this budget, not a last-minute tip. Ask your host to confirm the appropriate arrangements.

Documents & the levy

Check entry permission and arrival requirements for your passport through Indonesia's official immigration service. This sample assumes no nationality. The provincial visitor levy is separate from a visa; the listed charge is Rp150,000 per foreign visitor, subject to official exemptions.



Official Bali visitor-levy portal
lovebali.baliprov.go.id
Scan or tap the link.

Indonesia Immigration
Provincial visitor code
Provincial levy information

> Money, entry and access information was checked on 29 October 2026. Recheck before departure; the public sample contains no bookings.

A little transparency belongs in the luggage.

Original editorial writing and design.
Real places. A deliberately fictional journey.

The sample brief

Two anonymous adults; one double room; six nights, split 3 + 3 between Ubud and Sidemen. A May shoulder-season week, with no exact dates or travel year assigned. Modest independent stays, local food, art, short walks and weaving. Ground target Rp12m for two; flights, visas and insurance excluded. No bookings or availability checks are implied.

Reading & practical sources

1. UNESCO: Bali's cultural landscape and Voices of Water inform the subak essay.
2. Museum Puri Lukisan: institutional story; visitor page: hours and admission.
3. ITDC: Sidemen endek and songket informs the textile essay. Historical prices there are not used.
4. Ibu Mangku menus; Biah Biah's claimed listing; Embang's owner-supplied listing.
5. Jati room details; Pondok Satu Hati 4; Sawah Indah room comparison.
6. Travelfish: Embang, inspection updated 2025. Room conditions and current reviews still need rechecking.
7. Provincial levy and visitor code. Transfer times and budgets are editorial estimates.

Photography & reuse

Rice terraces, Ubud, Bali (Tegallalang), © Vyacheslav Argenberg / vascoplanet.com, 2010. CC BY 4.0. Cover and page 3: resized and cropped, cover darkened by an overlay.

Museum Puri Lukisan grounds, Chainwit., 2022. CC BY 4.0. Page 4: resized and cropped.

Sate Lilit, Kresnanta, 2018. CC BY-SA 4.0. Page 6: resized and cropped; adapted image retains that licence. Not photographed at a recommended restaurant.

Sidemen hills, I Gede Krisna Dharmayudha, 2024. CC BY-SA 4.0. Page 7: resized and cropped; adapted image retains that licence.

Map & typography

Bali coastline: Natural Earth, public domain, 1:10m country geometry. Public town and airport points are approximate. The dotted connector is a trip sequence, not a road map.

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Before you book

Confirm dates, total room prices, cancellation, breakfast, exact room, current access and transfer arrangements. Neither an attractive gallery nor this guide guarantees quiet, working Wi-Fi, accessibility or a view.

Good days do not need to be expensive. They need to be chosen.

Research reviewed 29 October 2026. Full public evidence and rights ledger: sources.md / sources.json. This guide was composed from public sources, not from personal travel records.